CURRICULUM VITAE

MAJA U. PEDERSEN

Historical Economics and Development Group (HEDG)
Department of Economics
University of Southern Denmark
Campusvej 55, Odense M
5230, Denmark
E-mail: mup@sam.sdu.dk

Professional Profile

My area of research is within economic history, with a particular focus on economic growth, labour markets, and long-run economic development. A central theme throughout my work has been the reconstruction and analysis of historical sources, focusing on economic activity and human capital. I have studied topics including women's labour force participation, social mobility, Malthusian mechanisms in Denmark and Italy, and market integration. My research combines quantitative methods with detailed archival work and the construction of novel historical datasets from sources such as manorial accounts, biographies, student records, and trade data. Through this work, I have developed expertise in recovering, classifying, and analysing information from diverse historical sources. More recently, I have expanded my methodological toolbox through projects applying machine learning and large language models in economic history, opening new opportunities for source analysis and historical research.

Fields of Specialization

Primary: Economic History, Applied Economics

Secondary: Economic growth, agricultural economics

Education

01/09/2018-19/01/2023	**PhD in Economic History**, University of Southern Denmark (SDU), *under the supervision of Professor Paul Richard Sharp* *Title: Topics in Economic History and Growth*
2017-2020	**MSc in Macroeconomics and Growth**, Department of Economics, University of Southern Denmark (DK) *Title: Malthus in preindustrial Northern Italy?*
2013-2016	**BSc in Economics**, University of Bari Aldo Moro (IT)

Employment

01/10/2026-	**Research Assistant** *University of Southern Denmark*
01/07/2023- 30/09/2026	**Assistant Professor** *University of Southern Denmark*
01/02/2023- 30/06/2023	**Postdoctoral fellow** *Part of the H2020 project INCULTUM.*
11/2023-02/2023	**Researcher** Researcher on the project: *The value of social background, education, academic performance and work experience: Following the life course of Scandinavian high school, technical school and university-level graduate cohorts 1880-1920, financed by Handelsbanken Sweden*
09/2018-08/2020	**Research Assistant** *University of Southern Denmark, under the supervision of Professor Paul Richard Sharp*

Teaching Experience

Teaching assistant, undergraduate courses

2019-2020	Macroeconomics
2019-2020	Economic History

Lecturer, undergraduate courses

2021	Economic History
2025	Statistics
2025-2026	Social and Economic Statistics
2026	Economics Beyond Growth: Development within Planetary Boundaries

Lecturer, graduate courses

2022	Advanced Economic Evaluation

Teaching competencies:
I have completed the SDU Lecturer Training Programme, which has enabled me to develop and apply new teaching methods and strengthen my pedagogical practice. In my teaching, I focus on supporting the students' learning process and creating engaging learning environments.

Research leadership:
Although I have not yet served as principal investigator, I have participated in several large externally funded research projects, providing experience in project coordination, leadership, and collaboration. In the HORIZON 2020 project INCULTUM, I co-managed, together with the work package leader, the daily administrative activities of the work package and played a leading role in communication and coordination across the international consortium.

Grants and Awards

2023	2nd Runner-up Paper Award at the Advances in Tourism Marketing Conference in Bordeaux for the paper: *Using big data to measure cultural tourism in Europe with unprecedented precision*.
2021	EHA Exploratory Travel and Data Grant. Awarded the maximum amount of $2500.

Management Experience

2023-2024	**Investigator** - **INCULTUM consortium**, funded by **Horizon2020** to study cultural tourism to the periphery in Europe. Supporting the work package leader in project management and analysis of big data, which has improved my research management skills.
2023-3034	**Investigator** - *Tourism flows in European destinations during and after the Covid-19 pandemic*, funded by the **Mobile Lives Forum.** Supporting the PI in the analysis of millions of observations to validate a new database and show one application of the data.
2025-2026	**Seminar organizer** - Part of a committee organizing a seminar in connection with International Women's Day 2026.

Other Skills

Languages	Danish, native English, fluent Italian, fluent

List of Publications

[9] Borowiecki, K. J., Pedersen, M.U. and Palomeque, M. (2025). "Putting the Periphery on the Map: Tourism Activity Measured with Big Data". *Tourism Economics*.*

[8] Jensen, P.S., Pedersen, M.U., Radu, C. and Sharp, P (2025). "All in a Day's Work: Evidence from Danish Manorial Accounts on Labor, Seasonality, and Living Standards". *European Review of Economic History*.

[7] Borowiecki, K. J., Pedersen, M.U. and Mitchell, S. B. (2024). "Using big data to measure cultural tourism in Europe". *Tourism Economics*, 31(3): 477-503.

[6] Pedersen, M., Geloso, V. and Sharp, P. (forthcoming). "Globalization and Empire: Market integration and international trade between Canada, the United States and Britain, 1750-1870". *Social Science History*.

[5] Maerean, A. A., Pedersen, M. and Sharp, P. (2022). "'Propitious contrast': Romanian borrowing in a Balkan mirror, 1878-1913". Financial History Review: 1-24.

[4] Jensen, P. S., Pedersen, M., Radu, C. and Sharp, P. (2022). "Arresting the Sword of Damocles: The transition to the post-Malthusian Era in Denmark". *Explorations in Economic History*, https://doi.org/10.1016/j.eeh.2021.101437

[3] Pedersen, M. and Sharp, P. (2021). "The Cost of Ignorance: Reputational Mark-up in the Market for Tuscan Red Wines". *Journal of International Wine Business Research*.

[2] Boberg-Fazlic, N., Lampe, M., Pedersen, M. and Sharp. P. (2021). "Pandemics and Protectionism: Evidence from the "Spanish" flu". *Humanities & Social Sciences Communications*,

[1] Pedersen, M., Riani, C. And Sharp, P. (2021). "Malthus in Pre-industrial Northern Italy?". *Journal of Population Economics*.

Book Chapters

[1] Borowiecki, Karol J., Pedersen, Maja U., Mitchell, Sara and Alam Khan, Shahedul. "*Navigating Cultural Landscapes: Approaches to Data Collection and Analysis in Tourism"*. In Karol J. Borowiecki, Jose Maria Civantos and Antonella Fresa (Eds.): *Visiting the Margins: Innovative Cultural Tourism in European Peripheries*, London: Routledge. 2024, (BFI 2).

Work in Progress

[1] Latifundia to Liberation: Land Reform as a Path to Female Emancipation in 1950s Italy. *Solo authored paper*

[2] The Great Fire of London and the Economic Activity in the City of London, *with Philipp Ager, Frederikke Frehr Kristensen, Xanthi Tsoukli and Paul Sharp.*

[3] Educational Reform and the Social Background of Norwegian Graduates
with Paul Sharp, Kristin Ranestad and Nina Boberg Fazlic

[4] The Schleswig-Holstein Question Revisited: Social Mobility and National Identity
with Paul Sharp and Nina Boberg Fazlic